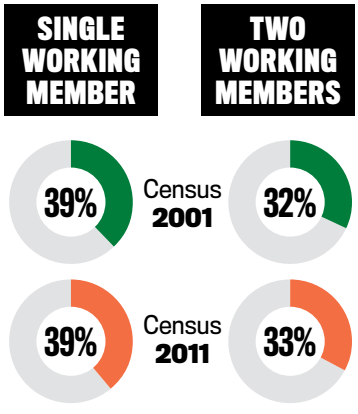


GETTY IMAGES

'DOUBLE INCOME NO KIDS' FAMILIES

42% rural families have only two working members and no children, it's 22% in cities

HOUSEHOLDS SUSTAINING ON THE INCOME OF



DIVORCE

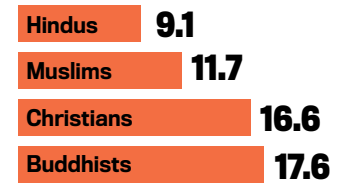
The rate of divorce has gone up in the past 15 years in India, but it's still one of the lowest in the world

ONLY **13** MARRIAGES OUT OF 1,000 END IN DIVORCE IN INDIA

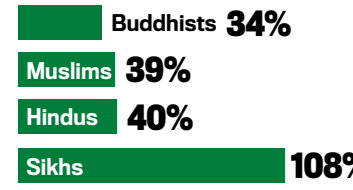
1.36 million PEOPLE IN INDIA ARE DIVORCED. THAT IS EQUIVALENT TO 0.24% OF THE MARRIED POPULATION, AND 0.11% OF THE TOTAL POPULATION

SEPARATED AND DIVORCED WOMEN BY RELIGION

Out of every 1,000 who have ever married

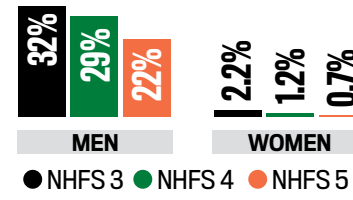


Increase between 2001 and 2011

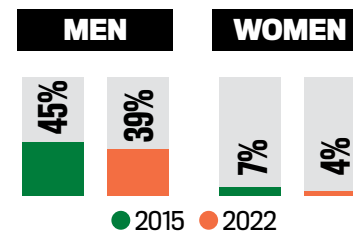


Source: Census 2011

ALCOHOL USE



TOBACCO USE



for less offspring reflects in the national fertility rate too. India's current figure of 2 children per person is lower than the global replacement rate of 2.1.

When it comes to personal habits—there has been a decline in both alcohol and tobacco use in the past 15 years, a result attributable to both government initiatives and growing public awareness. Instead, Indians are now adopting lifestyles that did not even exist back in 1947. The internet and its services have brought massive changes post the 1990s. Today, the country is one of the world's largest markets for food delivery, social media networks and app-based dating. On December 31, 2021, Swiggy and Zomato processed 4.5 million orders here, WhatsApp users number a humongous 530 million, and India offered dating apps their second largest revenue market after the US. More Indians are reaching for their phones to upgrade and enrich their lives—whether it is having an affair, sending a Diwali present or having a 'movie party' with friends in sundry locations, our social interactions today are nearly always part-virtual.

Despite the digitisation of society and changing household sizes, family remains an integral part of Indian society. The country still has one of the lowest divorce rates in the world—a mere 0.24 per cent of the married population compared to 2.7 per cent in the US. The structure of a family might be morphing but it still revolves around largely the same values of solidity. ■